



Founder Varun Heta who started Nuts and Boltz in Delhi after experiencing the want of a community while teaching himself robotics

The origins of Workbench Projects is more clinical by comparison yet it reflects the same eagerness to get ideas off the drawing board. Cofounders of Workbench, Kumar and Anupama Prakash met while collaborating with an organisation that tried to encourage experiential learning of math and science in schools. “We got to collaborate on a very specific project to build a math activity centre called NumberNagar for primary and middle schoolers. It was a project that emphasised on user based experience design to make math teaching and learning highly multidisciplinary. The approach to the project demanded both aesthetic and functional design that called for several iterations during its execution,” explains Prakash.

It was at this time that they realised that the city (Bangalore) did not have a space dedicated for prototyping. “One with ideas was either let loose to run pillar to post in search of different studio offerings rather than having a one-stop joint for idea exploration. The need was hence clearly defined” she adds.

Kumar came with the proposition to start a studio for idea exploration. They spent three months researching online, meeting with like-minded people, following which a white paper was articulated and shared with many international organisations from University professors to Fab Labbers. Fab Labs are licensed makerspaces, franchises if you may. The terminology has more to do with the way the space is run and managed than with the work that is done and leaves the space.